

Open Source in the Enterprise: A Change in the Climate

Open source software is freely available for use to enterprises. It is a well known fact that major corporations and enterprises like Google, Facebook, Amazon, Bank of America and many others use open source software. This article highlights the open source software available to enterprises for different purposes.



Enterprise class IT is mainly characterised by the following key attributes—reliability, scalability, security, manageability and serviceability. The enterprise hardware and software stack needs to be highly reliable to cater to mission-critical workloads. The workload running on the enterprise IT infrastructure may require more resources from time to time; hence, it needs to be designed to scale seamlessly in all aspects. Since much crucial and confidential data is stored and analysed on IT machines, security becomes an important aspect of the IT infrastructure, which should be built with superior security features.

Periodic updates are needed for the IT infrastructure in terms of software upgrades, bug fixes and hardware replacement. This demands that the enterprise IT infrastructure should have a swift serviceability policy.

Enterprise class IT typically consists of a large number of resources like servers, storage and networking and various software products running on them. Having simple and easy-to-use manageability solutions will help in better resource utilisation and higher productivity.

Open source in the enterprise – the change has begun

The enterprise segment is undergoing changes like never before with the advent of the cloud consumption model. There is a great push from customers for more cost-effective solutions.

Large organisations are looking at viable alternatives that allow more agility, helping them to stay ahead in the market by innovating speedily. It is no surprise that reducing operational IT expenditure, while simultaneously increasing the level of security and software capabilities, is a top priority for most enterprises. Open source products and processes address all these requirements.

- **Greater transparency:** Not only is the source code available, but all of the design deliberations are out in the open, in contrast to the secretive processes of proprietary vendors. This transparency makes it easy to assess the product and its community before deciding whether to use it.
- **Greater innovation:** Since open source solutions have a large community of experienced developers volunteering to work on them, the pace and level of innovation is